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"MAHARASHTRA, BIHAR, KARNATAKA ARE CRUCIAL FOR THE BJP IF IT HAS TO MAKE 370-PLUS SEATS A REALITY"

PRADEEP GUPTA
CMD, AxisMyIndia

"Around 80 per cent of BJP's weak seats are in the south and east. That's why the BJP has a look south and a look east policy. They are looking at short- and long-term gains"

AMITABH TIWARI
Political Strategist and Election Analyst

"YOU HAVE NEVER SEEN A LOK SABHA ELECTION WHERE YOU COULD PICK A WINNER WELL BEFORE THE ELECTION"

G.V.L. NARASIMHA RAO
Rajya Sabha Member, BJP

plus was possible.

Gupta explained that if the NDA has to cross the 400 mark, it would be critical for the BJP to repeat their performance in about 250-odd seats where the saffron party has had a strike rate of more than 90 per cent. He mentioned four states—Maharashtra, Bihar, Karnataka and Delhi—that would be crucial in this regard. One factoid everyone agreed on was that the Congress could be the weak link in the I.N.D.I.A. formation, while for the NDA, it will be the regional allies.

Deshmukh feels the BJP's vote share may jump to 41 per cent from 37 per cent last time and NDA's to 46 per cent from 45 per cent. For him, the crucial fight will be in the 243 seats where the BJP is pitted against regional parties. Tiwari said the BJP had been giving special attention to south and east because 80 per cent of its weak seats are in these two regions. ■